

the two opposing powers. Light and darkness, health and sickness, knowledge and ignorance, love and hate—these were antitheses necessarily linked with the conception of Ormazd and Ahriman. Life and death could clearly not be omitted; and the certainly Magian notion of the supremely polluting power of a corpse would tend to suggest that the good Spirit must annul that which was so conspicuously the triumph of his foe. This, however, only meant that the Magi accepted immortality, not that they inherited a doctrine based on the analogy of nature, like the unreformed Iranian religion, or like Zarathushtra could contribute original and profound thought to the establishment of the far-reaching conception which was to influence so widely the religious thinking of men. The more characteristically Magian speculations—the flattened earth, the vanishing of shadows, the uniformity of speech, and the like—I have dealt with elsewhere. How far these Magian ideals contribute to the enhancement of happiness in the world that is to be, the reader may judge for himself.

Meanwhile, among the Iranian peoples whose belief in a future life Zarathushtra had inherited and developed, the picturesque and mythical side of the doctrine naturally went on gathering new features. The hints of the Gathas were improved upon—if, indeed, we must not generally say that the Gathas have reduced to mere hints elements of mythus already existing, which in post-reformation days recovered all their old exuberance. For example, the Gathas allude¹ to the nectar and ambrosia—if we

¹ See *Ys* 34¹¹ and note (p. 363).